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Learn about copyright and federal government materials

Text, images, and logos you see on federal websites may be subject to copyright or other restrictions. Learn the rules before using materials from government websites.

Find U.S. government materials you can use

The Library of Congress (LOC) has a special collection of federal government materials that are not subject to copyright protection.

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- Search LOC's digital collections to [find copyright-free books, newspapers, maps, music, films, and more](#).

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Endorsement, trademarks, and agency logos

You cannot use government materials in a way that implies endorsement by a government agency, official, or employee.

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- For example, in general, you cannot use an agency logo or trademark on your social media page to suggest endorsement or sponsorship by the agency.

Attribution

In some cases, agencies will have specific language that they request you include with the materials they allow you to use. In other cases, agencies may release copyright-protected materials under a Creative Commons “CC-BY” or similar license, which requires attribution for use.

State and local government materials

The U.S. government work designation does not apply to works of state and local governments. Those works may be protected by copyright. [Contact your state](#) or [local government](#) for more information about their copyrighted works.

Copyright laws differ internationally

U.S. copyright laws may not protect U.S. government works outside the country. But the work may be protected under the copyright laws of other jurisdictions when used in these jurisdictions. The U.S. government may assert copyright outside of the United States for U.S. government works.

Learn more about U.S. government works and copyright law

- [Copyright Law of the United States of America, Sections 101 and 105](#) – Read the section of the law that describes U.S. government works.
- [U.S. Copyright Office Compendium, Section 313.6\(C\)\(1\)\[PDF, 695KB\]](#) – Learn about “works of the U.S. government” and exceptions.
- [Frequently asked questions about copyright\[PDF, 1.4MB\]](#) – Find answers to common questions about U.S. government works.
- [Difference between patents, trademarks, service marks, and copyrights](#) – Many people confuse copyrights with patents and trademarks. Learn about the different types of intellectual property and get examples of each.
- [Visit the U.S. Copyright Office website](#) to search copyright records and to register your work.

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